
Pitch Deck

GAM 200

Game Changes

Team Bloop

Terms to take note

01

TEMPO

The constant musical speed (BPM) of the game's soundtrack.

02

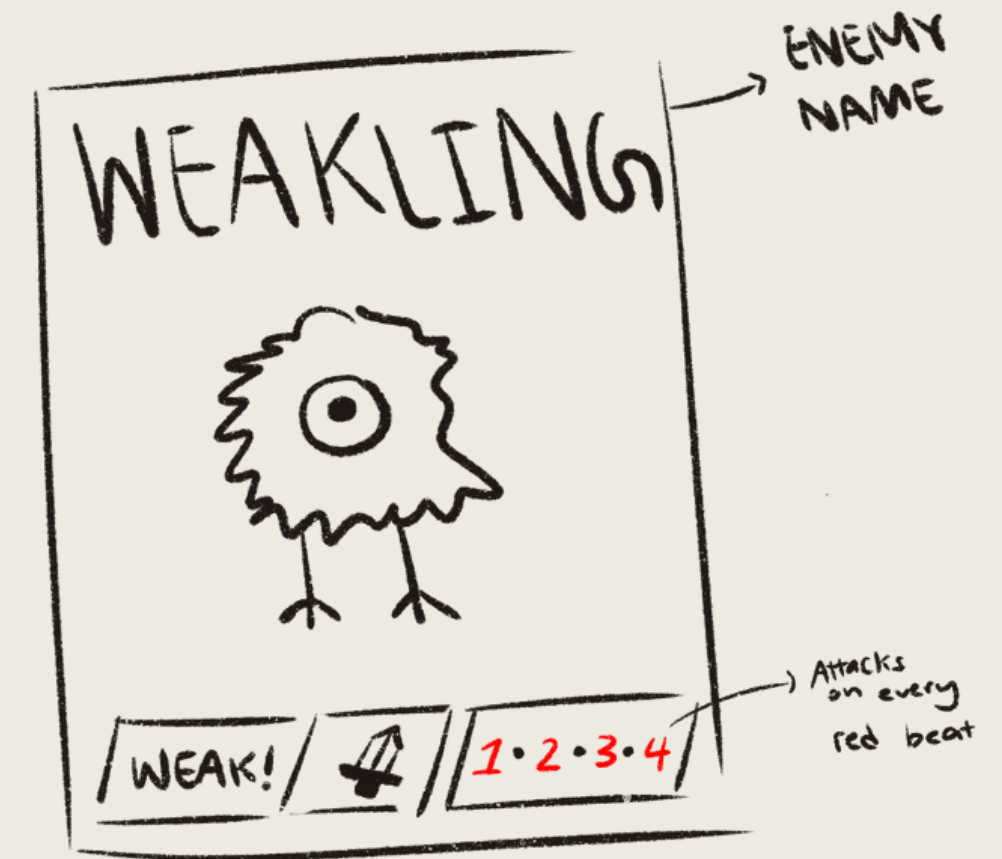
RHYTHM PATTERN:

The unique way each enemy moves within that tempo.

03

ORDER SLIP

Placeholder name for UI with information for player on weapon of current enemy weakness + enemy rhythm pattern



Core Gameplay Concept

The player fights enemies **one at a time** by pressing rhythmic 4-beat weapon combos that must be performed in time with the enemy's movement rhythm and match the enemy's weapon weakness.

Concept Details

Each enemy moves and attacks according to a distinct rhythm pattern (e.g. fast, slow, hold).

The player must:

1. Identify the rhythm pattern through the enemy's animation.
2. Remember the weakness
3. Input the correct 4-beat combo matching the right weapon in sync with that rhythm.

If timed correctly, the player's weapon activates **automatically** on the final beat, dealing damage or killing the enemy.

Phase	What Happens	Player's Goal
Preparation	Before combat begins, a short holographic "Order Slip" appears, showing the next enemy's weapon weakness and rhythm type (how fast or slow it moves). The slip fades after 4 beats.	Memorise the weakness and observe the enemy's rhythm type before it disappears.
Fight Begins! <i>(Rhythm Recognition)</i>	The enemy enters and begins moving in sync with the background music. Each enemy has a different rhythm pattern, not a different tempo. (E.g. Weak Enemy: moves every beat → fast / Medium Enemy: moves every 2 beats → slower / Hold Enemy: charges for 2 beats, attacks on 3rd). This movement visually sets the rhythm you must follow.	Watch and listen carefully to feel the beat spacing for your inputs.
Action <i>(Combo Input)</i>	The player performs a 4-beat combo (e.g. W A W A) in time with the global music beat. Each combo corresponds to a specific weapon type (Spear, Sword, Bow, etc.). You must input the correct weapon combo in sync with the enemy's movement rhythm.	Press the correct 4-beat combo on time to ready the weapon that counters the enemy.
Auto Attack <i>(Resolution)</i>	When the 4-beat combo finishes, your equipped weapon automatically attacks on the final beat. If your combo and timing are correct, the attack hits. If your combo is wrong or mistimed, it misses – and the enemy counter-attacks once .	☒ If correct: Enemy hit! ☒ If wrong: Miss → enemy counter-attacks once.
Next Enemy Up <i>(Transition)</i>	After defeating the current enemy, a new "Next Up" Order Slip appears briefly to preview the next opponent's weakness and rhythm type before fading again.	Mentally prepare the next weapon combo and timing rhythm before the fight begins.

Key Gameplay Clarifications

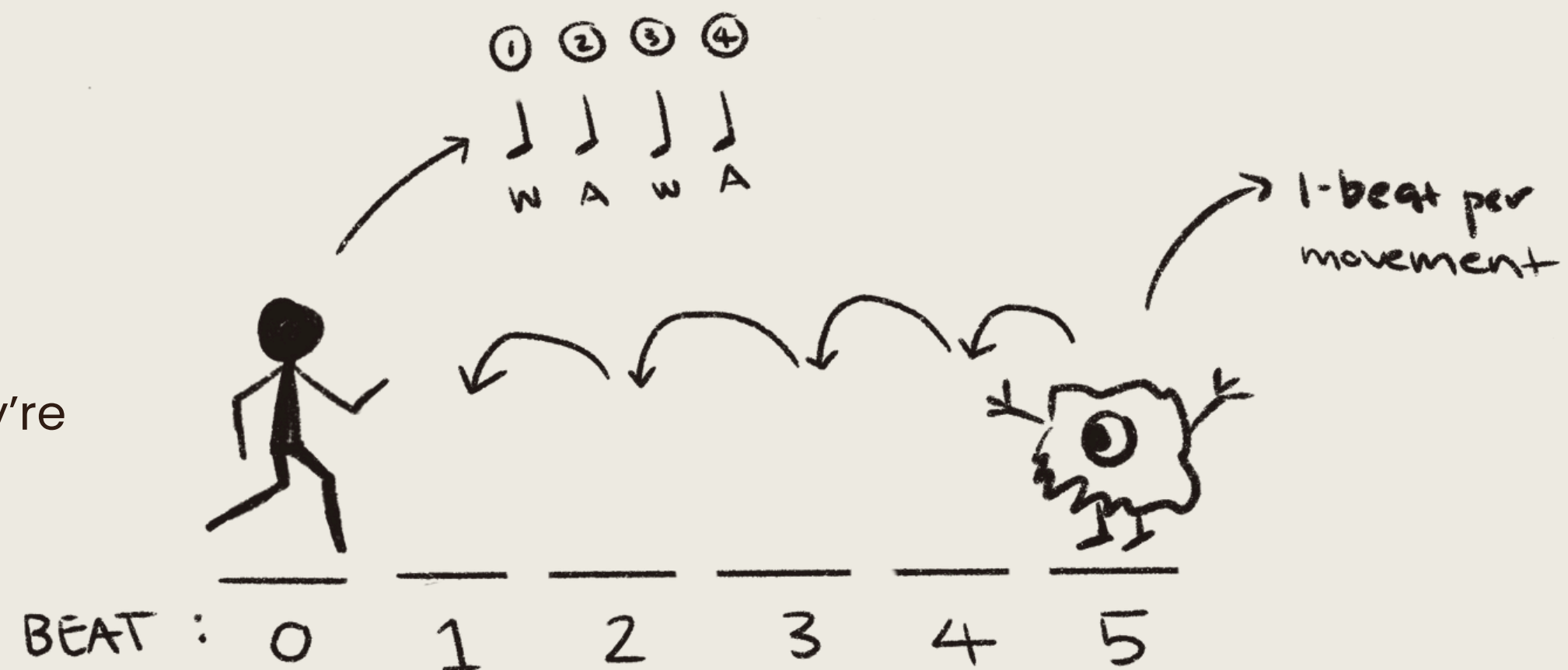
1. The music's tempo (BPM) never changes, all enemies move within the same beat.
2. Different enemies have different rhythm patterns, not different speeds.
3. The player always performs combos across 4 beats, regardless of the enemy's pattern
4. Combos are used to activate weapons, not to directly attack.
5. The fun comes from recognising each enemy's rhythm and responding musically on-beat

1. The music's tempo (BPM) never changes.

- The background music acts like the **heartbeat of the game**, one steady pulse that never speeds up or slows down
- Every system in the game (UI, player inputs, enemy motion, attacks) follows this same internal clock.
- Example: if the song is at 120 BPM (2 beats per second), **all timing and animations sync to that**, no exceptions.

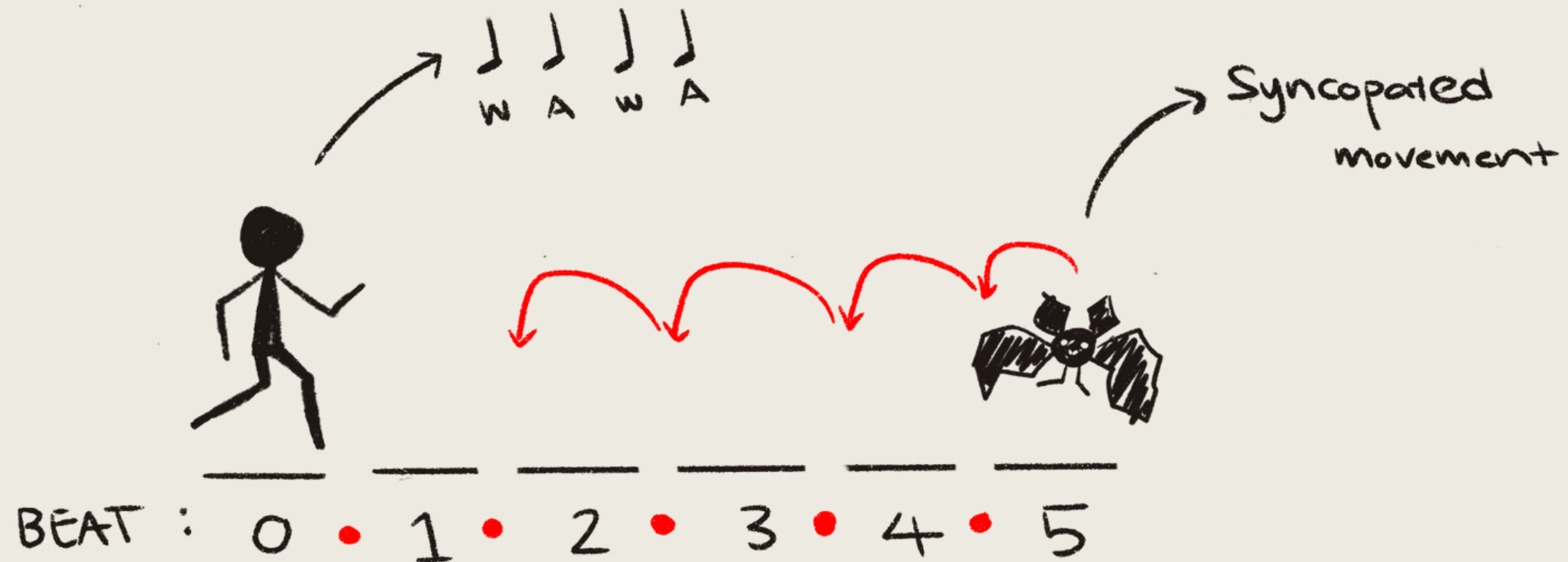
2. Different enemies have different rhythm patterns, not different speeds.

- All enemies move within the same beat timing, but in **different patterns** across the 4 beats.
- Example:
- Weak Enemy (1-beat type): moves every beat → 1, 2, 3, 4
- Medium Enemy (2-beat type): moves every two beats → 1, (pause), 3, (pause)
- Hold-type: charges for 2 beats, then attacks on beat 3 → 1-2 (charge), 3 (strike), 4 (pause)
- So they feel slower or faster, but technically they're all syncing to the same global beat count



3. The player always performs combos across 4 beats, regardless of the enemy's pattern.

- Every weapon combo (like W A W A) takes exactly 4 beats to complete, one key press per beat.
- **The difference is how it feels:** fast enemies move each beat while you play, while slow enemies might only move once or twice during your combo.
- You're always keeping time with the music, even if the enemy's movement is slower or more complex.



4. Combos are used to activate weapons, not to directly attack.

- Pressing the 4-beat combo doesn't instantly damage the enemy, it "charges" the corresponding weapon.
- Once the 4-beat combo finishes, the weapon automatically attacks on the final beat.
- Example: You perform W A W A → this activates your Spear → your Spear attack triggers automatically on beat 4.

5. The fun comes from recognising each enemy's rhythm and responding musically on-beat.

- The challenge isn't about reacting fast, it's about staying on beat while remembering the right combo for the enemy's weakness.
- Players use both their eyes (watching enemy movement) and ears (listening to the music beat).
- The satisfaction comes from executing your combo in sync with the rhythm and seeing it hit perfectly on the final beat.

Combo System Example

01

SPEAR (W A W A)

Fast, precise, ideal for short-beat enemies.

02

SWORD (S D S D)

Balanced, matches 2-beat enemies.

03

BOW (A S D D)

Long-range, good for hold-type enemies.

04

HAMMER (W A S D)

Heavy charge, strong against slow bosses.

Once the correct 4-beat combo is performed, the player “loads” that weapon, it auto-attacks on the final beat. **(Combos aren’t attacks themselves, they’re how you equip and execute the right weapon on-beat.)**

Enemy Rhythm Movement Patterns

Enemy	Rhythm Pattern	Example Movement	Enemy Note Timing	Player Counter Combo	How Combo Aligns with Enemy Movement
Weak	1 beat per step	Step → Step → Step → Attack	 (4 crotchets)		Perfect 1:1 match, press each beat with the enemy's step.
Tank	2 beats per step	Step → pause → Step → pause	 (2 minims)		Each enemy move spans 2 of your presses (press 2 keys per enemy step).
Hold-Type	Charges for 2 beats, attacks on 3rd, rests on 4th.	Charge (1-2) → Smash (3) → Pause (4)	 (minim + crotchet + rest)		You press W slightly longer (beat-and-half), then quickly tap A (half-beat) to mimic the charge-release feel.
Hold-Stop	Holds and stops on beats 2 and 4.	Move → Freeze → Move → Freeze	 (dotted crotchet + quaver pattern)		Player alternates between long and short presses, long notes match enemy freezes, short ones match small windows of motion.
Agile	Moves between main beats (off-beat hops).	Small hop on the "and"s between beats.	 (syncopated quavers)		You press on the beat while enemy moves off it, creating syncopation, your attack catches them as they land.

Take Note! [Engine]

Even when the enemy's rhythm pattern uses holds or pauses, the player's combo inputs are still spread evenly across the 4 beats. The **feel of timing changes**, NOT the number of inputs.

Take Note! [Design]

Hold-type combos require the player to keep the key pressed through the full beat duration; the Conductor checks held inputs

Take Note! [Art]

Enemy animation keyframes are **aligned with the same global beat count.**

For example, a 2-beat enemy hits animation key poses on beats 1 and 3 within the same music tempo.